

Students let the bot do the work

Most high schoolers use AI, raising fresh doubts about value of home work assignments.

By Howard Blume

Homework has long been a topic of debate, but in 2025 it is facing an existential crisis: Has artificial intelligence and its instant answers made it pointless or even counterproductive? Research released this month suggests that AI has become fully embedded in how students respond to homework and other assignments. The percentage of high school students who report using generative AI for schoolwork is growing, increasing from an already high 79% to 84% between January and May of this year, according to surveys conducted by College Board, the nonprofit that manages much of the nation's standardized tests, including the SAT.

That means increasing numbers of students are assigning their own homework to AI — even if it puts learning at peril. AI can solve a math problem and also show the work step by step. It can summarize and analyze a reading passage. It can write an entire essay, in ways increasingly difficult to spot. Inglewood high school English teacher Alyssa Bolden learned from one of her students that AI could customize an essay by incorporating the student's notes from Bolden's lectures as well as her unique evaluation rubric. AI has given her an overpowering reason to consider homework pointless. "They're not doing it," she said of students and homework. "They're not doing it." Other teachers, however, continue to assign homework, which introduces a new tension in the learning relationship, said 10th-grader Aaliyah Herron, 15, who is one of Bolden's students at City Honors International Preparatory High School. In other classes, she finds herself having to prove her innocence given the quality of her work. She avoids AI to eliminate any possibility that she could be accused of using it improperly: "My essays will get marked as AI for no reason — even though I haven't used AI for any single paper in my life." Fundamentally, AI complicates a preexisting problem: Often, instructors have put too little thought into homework, said Mollie Galoway, associate professor at the Graduate School of Education and Counseling at [See Homework, A9]



PHOTOGRAPHS BY JULIANA YAMADA LOS ANGELES TIMES
PILAR CUEVAS, above, a teacher at La Tijera Academy of Excellence in Inglewood, top, has her students handwrite their homework, making AI use harder.

AUSTRIA'S TREASURE, MEXICO'S HERITAGE

Officials want 'Moctezuma's headdress' returned from Vienna. But is it too fragile?

By Patrick J. McDonnell
REPORTING FROM VIENNA



KHM-Museumsverband
THE ARTIFACT has become a "highly politicized symbol."

On their 30th wedding anniversary, the couple from Mexico were determined to fulfill a long-deferred aspiration: a visit to this storied former Hapsburg capital. And they didn't come just to catch an opera and savor the Sachertorte. "We always wanted to see *el penacho de Moctezuma*," said Gema Vargas, referring to the feathered headdress widely attributed to the legendary Aztec emperor. "It's much more beautiful than we imagined." But, she added: "It should be in Mexico."

For more than a century, Mexican officials have called the penacho a cultural touchstone and sought its return from Austria — despite no evidence that Moctezuma actually wore it. Austrian officials insist the brittle object is too delicate to move from its perch in Vienna's renowned Weltmuseum. Despite its lore and beauty, the penacho suffers from a case of contested identity: In Austria, it is a treasured possession of the state. In Mexico, it remains a marker of national identity. "One has to think of *el penacho* in two [See Headdress, A4]

Big wave machine rolls into beach city

By Roger Vincent

The coastal city of El Segundo is an unlikely location for a massive, new artificial surf park. Other California surf parks with machine-powered wave pools are inland, far from natural waves in places such as Palm Springs and Lemoore in the San Joaquin Valley. This summer, an owner of one of those parks, Palm Springs Surf Club, bought 10 acres of land on a former aerospace campus in El Segundo. The location is near a bonanza of sports enterprises that have sprung up in recent years, including a Topgolf entertainment complex and the training facility and headquarters of the Los Angeles Chargers football team.

A company tied to billionaire Vinny Smith's Toba Capital paid \$54 million for the site, said Colin O'Byrne, president of Inland Pacific Cos., the development partner of Toba Capital. Smith, a tech mogul and surfer, and a major investor in the Palm Springs Surf Club, reportedly got involved after testing a wave prototype. The El Segundo surf park, which has yet to be named, will hold about 5 million gallons of water in a 2.2-acre lagoon, O'Byrne said. He hopes to secure city approval to start work on the project, valued at \$175 million, in about six months. El Segundo is already a legit surfing town, known for its custom surfboard shapers and waves at El Segundo Beach Jetty. [See Waves, A11]

My matcha latte costs how much?

By Stephanie Yang

The matcha drinks at Kin Bakeshop are so popular that some customers wait hours for their fix. The little Santa Barbara cafe was going through more than 4 pounds of the Japanese tea on its busiest days when it started getting tough to get a reliable supply. The matcha dealer called in the summer to say that after a decade of importing from Japan, she had been forced to start rationing supply. There was no longer enough of the potent powder for everyone. Kin Bakeshop found new supplies and hiked its prices, but the customers kept coming, said Tommy Chang, owner of the cafe. "It's like the harder that it

is to get your hands on it, the more people want it," he said. "They just need their matcha. They'll come here no matter what." A growing thirst for matcha is rolling a delicate supply chain from Japanese tea farms to California's cafes. The tea leaves are grown in the shade, specially processed and then stone-ground into the bright green, earthy powder used in drinks and desserts. As matcha's bold aesthetic and health benefits have taken social media and consumers by storm, Japanese production is under strain from an aging population and hotter climate. That's sent prices surging, and businesses scrambling to secure supply. Exacerbating the problem is the fact that coffee [See Matcha, A12]

'Make or break moment' for the Supreme Court

Ruling will decide what, if any, limits exist to president's use of military in the U.S.

By David G. Savage

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court is set to rule for the first time on whether the president has the power to deploy troops in American cities over the objections of local and state officials. A decision could come at any time. And even a one-line order siding with President Trump would send the message that he is free to use the military to carry out his orders — and in particular, in Democratic-controlled cities and states. Trump administration lawyers filed an emergency appeal last week asking the court to reverse judges in Chicago who blocked the deployment of the National Guard there. The Chicago-based judges said Trump exaggerated the threat faced by federal immigration agents and had equated "protests with riots." Trump administration lawyers, however, said these judges had no authority to second-guess the president.

The power to deploy the National Guard "is committed to his exclusive discretion by law," they asserted in their appeal in Trump vs. Illinois. That broad claim of executive power might win favor with the court's conservatives. Administration lawyers told the court that the National Guard would "defend federal personnel, property, and functions in the face of ongoing violence" in response to aggressive immigration enforcement, but it would not carry out ordinary policing. Yet Trump has repeatedly threatened to send U.S. troops to San Francisco and other Democratic-led cities to carry out ordinary law enforcement. When he sent 4,000 Guard members and 700 Marines to Los Angeles in June, their mission was to protect federal buildings from protesters. But state officials said troops went beyond that and were used to carry out a show in force in MacArthur Park in July. [See Justices, A8]

A head-spinning array of lawsuits
The latest efforts to block or deploy the National Guard. **NATION, A8**

Trump ends trade talks with Canada

President cites TV ad backed by province featuring remarks by Reagan about tariffs.

By Will Weissert, Seung Min Kim and Rob Gillies

WASHINGTON — President Trump announced he's ending "all trade negotiations" with Canada because of a television ad sponsored by one of its provinces that used the words of former President Reagan to criticize U.S. tariffs — prompting the province's leader to later pull the ad. The post on Trump's social media site Thursday night ratcheted up tensions with the U.S.'s northern neighbor after Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said he plans to double his country's exports to countries outside the U.S. because of the threat posed

by Trump's tariffs. White House officials said Trump's reaction was a culmination of the administration's long, pent-up frustration about Canada's strategy in trade talks. Later Friday, Ontario Premier Doug Ford, whose province had sponsored the ad, said it would be taken down. Ford said after talking with Carney he's decided to pause the advertising campaign effective Monday so that trade talks can resume. Ford said they've achieved their goal, having reached U.S. audiences at the highest levels. "Our intention was always to initiate a conversation about the kind of economy that Americans want to build and the impact of tariffs on workers and businesses," Ford said. "We've achieved our goal, having reached U.S. audiences at the highest levels." The U.S. president al [See Tariffs ad, A6]



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WORLD SERIES BEGINS

Royal Canadian Police before the Dodgers-Blue Jays' Game 1. See **SPORTS, B12**, and visit latimes.com/enewspaper for coverage.



U.S. to monitor polling locations

Justice Department heeds Republican state lawmakers' request for oversight of Prop. 50 vote. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 74/57. **B8**

Markets **A12**
Opinion Voices **A13**
Obituaries **B3**

Mayor selects new LAFD chief

Bass, after nationwide search, names 30-year veteran Jaime Moore to lead the department. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

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